



BCSO PERSONNEL ADMINISTRATION BUREAU

Ricky Bot v1

Owner's Manual and Server Administrator Reference

A technical operating guide for the Discord personnel workflow bot

This manual describes what the bot does, what it never does, how approvals work, and exactly how to install, test, operate, and troubleshoot it. It is written for server owners, developers, Command, and PAB staff.

Repository: github.com/union95bb2/bcso-ricky-personnel-bot

Current command matrix: 19 guild slash commands | Human approval required for every consequential action

1. Read this first

Ricky Bot is a Discord workflow application. It turns a small amount of factual staff input into a consistent BCSO/PAB record, sends it to the configured destination, and leaves a searchable receipt. It does not replace PAB or Command judgment.

The bot is not an autonomous disciplinary, Internal Affairs, promotion, or personnel-jacket system. It never decides that a member is guilty, inactive enough for discipline, eligible for promotion, or deserving of removal.

The operating model is deliberately two-stage:

- Capture: a staff member selects real Discord members and roles, completes a guided form, and receives a private preview.
- Review: the authorized human approves, cancels, or corrects the preview. The bot performs only the action authorized by that approval.
- Audit: the final Discord record and private SQLite receipt preserve what was posted, who submitted it, and which action occurred.

Scope boundary

In scope	Out of scope
Training, department, qualification, rank-request, status, activity-review, announcement, correction, search, audit export, live-role snapshot.	IA complaints, investigations, evidence, findings, sanctions, discipline decisions, personnel-jacket history, automatic removals, automatic inactivity discipline.

The separate inactivity-review workflow is allowed because it is a neutral staff-attention record. It reports activity evidence and follow-up; it does not make a disciplinary finding or alter access/roles.

2. What is installed

The production repository is a Node.js Discord application using discord.js, a local SQLite operational ledger, a guild-bound command registration path, startup readiness gates, and a single-instance process lock.

Component	Function	Owner action
Discord application	Receives slash commands, renders forms, posts embeds, applies approved role changes.	Keep token private; grant least-privilege permissions.
SQLite ledger	Stores pending approvals and durable receipt metadata for search/export.	Protect the data directory and back it up under the server's personnel-record process.
Guild configuration	Maps channels, PAB/Command roles, rank roles, awardable roles, activity sources, and time zone.	Copy IDs carefully and validate with preflight and /pab-health.
Startup gate	Refuses to serve if IDs, destination channels, permissions, hierarchy, or command set are incomplete.	Treat a failed startup as a no-go, not as a warning.

The bot is guild-bound. A process configured for one guild ignores interactions from another guild, which prevents an old deployment from racing a sandbox or production instance.

Public source

The source, tests, configuration examples, release gates, and live command report are public at github.com/union95bb2/bcso-ricky-personnel-bot. Secrets, tokens, SQLite files, and server records are intentionally excluded.

3. Command reference

The following is the exact registered command surface. Discord presents the options and forms; staff should not type free-form member mentions or role names when a selector is available.

Command	Who uses it	What it does	Changes roles/access?
/setup-status	Server admin	Reports required ID/map configuration without showing secrets.	No
/pab-health	Server admin	Read-only checks channels, permissions, bot hierarchy, managed roles, and administrator guardrails.	No
/pab-dashboard	PAB	Private queue, completed count, recent activity, and quick-workflow links.	No
/export-audit	Server admin	Private JSON export of the local receipt ledger.	No
/member-profile	PAB	Private live snapshot of current Discord roles and join date.	No
/training-log	PAB	Guided trainer/trainee/division/date/time-zone/time form; preview then post.	No
/department-record	PAB	Branded department record with callsign, optional role fields, CC, and source link.	No
/promotion-check	PAB	Documents a human eligibility review in private PAB queue; not approval.	No
/promotion	PAB then Command	Creates promotion request; Command approval is the role-change control point.	Only after Command approval
/award-role	PAB	Adds one explicitly allow-listed qualification/unit role after preview approval.	Yes, allow-list only
/remove-role	PAB	Removes one explicitly allow-listed qualification/unit role after preview approval.	Yes, allow-list only
/personnel-status	PAB	Records leave, return, transfer, or separation; no access change.	No
/inactivity-review	PAB	Neutral activity review; computes last activity when the field is blank.	No
/pab-announcement	PAB	Reviewed announcement with optional safe notification role.	No
/find-record	PAB	Searches by member or PAB record ID.	No
/correct-record	PAB	Posts an immutable correction linked to an existing message; original remains.	No
/my-birthday	Any member	Opt-in birthday notice using month/day only; no birth year is stored.	No
/remove-birthday	Any member	Deletes that member's opt-in birthday data.	No
/roster-sync	Server admin	Read-only Google Sheet comparison showing missing IDs and rank mismatches.	No

The command list is exact for the current release. After changing command definitions, run the register command for the target guild and restart through the normal release gate.

4. Guided forms and input rules

Date fields use one format everywhere: MM/DD/YYYY. Promotion, role award/removal, personnel status, and training offer Today (prefill) or manual entry. Inactivity review uses MM/DD/YYYY - MM/DD/YYYY.

Training form

- Required selectors: trainer, trainee, division/program, date choice, and time zone.
- Optional hourly start/end dropdowns cover a one-hour day; the form validates the range and derives duration.
- The posted record carries the selected zone label, for example 4:00 PM MST - 5:00 PM MST.
- Invalid dates, reversed ranges, and malformed times are rejected before a preview exists.

Department record form

The member and optional role fields are Discord selectors. The factual note remains staff-entered. A source link can be preserved for traceability; Ricky Bot does not scrape or copy source-message content automatically.

Correction form

Use Discord's Copy Message Link on the original record. The bot validates the guild/message, captures the correction text, and creates a new linked record. It never edits or deletes the original.

Birthday and milestone settings

- Any human member may use `/my-birthday` with month and day to opt in. Ricky Bot stores no birth year and does not expose the stored date in a public command response.
- Use `/remove-birthday` at any time to opt out and delete the stored month/day.
- If the owner configures `BIRTHDAY_CHANNEL_ID`, Ricky Bot posts one annual mention.
`SERVICE_MILESTONES_CHANNEL_ID` enables informational one-month, three-month, six-month, and yearly notices based on the Discord join date and Ricky Bot's own approved promotion receipts for time in rank.

5. Discord server layout

Roles are a Discord server configuration concern, not a bot-code concern. Use inert separator roles to make the role list readable without granting permissions. Separator names such as -----BCSO | Awards----- and -----BCSO Divisions----- should have permissions 0, be non-mentionable, and never appear in the rank or awardable maps.

Required role model

Role	Purpose	Bot behavior
PAB	Staff allowed to submit/approve ordinary PAB workflows.	Checked for command authorization.
Command	Staff allowed to approve promotions.	Required at the promotion approval step.
Actual bot/controller role	The role assigned to Ricky Bot that Discord uses for hierarchy.	Must be above every rank/award role Ricky Bot must change; place it above PAB too when PAB members are targets.
Rank roles	Complete BCSO matrix: DST / Deputy Sheriff Trainee, Deputy, Senior Deputy, Corporal, Sergeant, Staff Sergeant, 2nd Lieutenant, 1st Lieutenant, Captain, Major, Commander, Division Chief, Chief Deputy, Assistant Sheriff, UnderSheriff, Sheriff.	Startup requires every canonical key in RANK_ROLE_IDS; only those roles are removed/replaced by promotion.
Qualification/unit roles	FTO, certifications, divisions, awards.	Only IDs in AWARDBLE_ROLE_IDS may be added/removed.
Category separators	Visual labels only.	Permissions 0; never assign to members or map to bot actions.

Hierarchy rule

Move the actual assigned Ricky Bot role above every configured RANK_ROLE_IDS and AWARDBLE_ROLE_IDS role. If PAB members may be promotion or qualification targets, move that same assigned role above PAB too; Discord otherwise refuses every role mutation on those members. This does not make PAB, Command, Administrator, or moderation roles editable because Ricky's allow-lists still block them. Moving an unassigned controller role does nothing. Ricky Bot can never manage the server owner.

PAB and Command approval roles must be normal mentionable roles (or Ricky Bot must have Mention Everyone) for restricted group pings to notify staff. /pab-health flags non-mentionable, managed, or elevated approval roles.

Recommended records category

Channel	Ordinary members	PAB/Command	Ricky Bot
#training-records	View	View/send	View/send/embed
#personnel-records	View	View/send	View/send/embed
#pab-approvals	No access	View/send	View/send/embed
#pab-audit-log	No access	View	View/send/embed
#qualification-records	View	View/send	View/send/embed
#promotion-announcements	View	View/send	View/send/embed
#pab-announcements	View	View/send	View/send/embed
#pab-inactivity-review	No access	View/send	View/send/embed

Normal text channels are the supported baseline. Forum/thread routing can be introduced later, after the primary text-channel workflow is stable.

6. Approval flows

Every consequential workflow has a private preview. The preview is the control boundary. If a field, member, role, channel, ping, or date is wrong, cancel and run the command again.

Training / department / status / announcement

- PAB selects members and roles, completes the form, and reviews the preview.
- PAB clicks Approve & post (or Approve & announce).
- Ricky Bot posts the formatted record to the configured destination and writes the receipt.

Promotion

- PAB runs /promotion and submits the factual request. No role changes occur.
- The request routes to private #pab-approvals.
- PAB clicks PAB review & forward after checking the member, current rank, new rank, date, authorization, and reference.
- Ricky Bot updates the request and pings Command. Only the Command approve & apply action can replace configured rank roles, post the personnel record, announce the promotion, and log the audit receipt.

Award / remove role

- PAB selects a member and an allow-listed qualification/unit role.
- Ricky Bot refuses rank, PAB, Command, managed, Administrator, or unallow-listed roles.
- PAB reviews the private preview and approves the single role mutation.

Inactivity review

- PAB selects a member and review period.
- Leave last-known activity blank to use the latest tracked timestamp from approved activity channels, or enter a verified override when the ledger has no event.
- The result is private and neutral. It applies no discipline, role change, access change, IA finding, or automatic removal.

Approval expiry, reminders, and renewal

- A preview lasts PENDING_ACTION_TTL_MINUTES (24 hours by default; administrators may configure 1 hour to 7 days). Every preview shows an absolute expiry timestamp and Discord's live relative countdown. A role-ping reminder is sent in private #pab-approvals during the PENDING_REMINDER_MINUTES window (1 hour by default).
- Every request pings the PAB role. Promotions use two gates: PAB clicks PAB review & forward, Ricky Bot updates the same request and pings Command, then Command clicks Command approve & apply for the final role change. The creator can click Renew to create a fresh approval window; Command may also renew a promotion request. The original action is still rechecked against current members, roles, and permissions at approval time.
- Expired previews fail closed; they never apply a late role change. Run the command again when facts or authorization need to be refreshed.

Google Sheet roster comparison

Configure a Viewer-only service account, spreadsheet ID, and range, share the sheet with that service-account email, and leave GOOGLE_SHEETS_ENABLED=false while preparing the mapping. When the server owner is ready, set it to true, restart Ricky Bot, and use /roster-sync as a server administrator. The expected header row includes discord_id and may include callsign, display_name, rank, role, and status. See GOOGLE_SHEETS_ROSTER.md for the exact setup. Ricky Bot reports differences for human review and never changes a Discord role from spreadsheet data.

7. Installation and configuration

Use a separate private sandbox before live cutover. The repository includes demo and sandbox examples with IDs but blank credentials. Keep the token and client ID only on the protected host.

Developer Portal

- Create the Ricky Bot application and bot user.
- Install with bot and applications.commands scopes.
- Grant only View Channels, Send Messages, Embed Links, Read Message History, Attach Files, Manage Roles, and Use Application Commands.
- Enable Server Members Intent. Do not grant Administrator.

Host preparation

Copy .env.example to .env on the protected host. Fill the IDs below. Never commit .env, data/, SQLite files, screenshots containing private personnel data, or credentials.

Variable	Required value
DISCORD_TOKEN	Protected bot token; never printed or pasted into Discord.
DISCORD_CLIENT_ID	Ricky Bot application client ID.
DISCORD_GUILD_ID	One target guild for this process.
PAB_ROLE_ID / COMMAND_ROLE_ID	Exact authorization role IDs.
*_CHANNEL_ID variables	Each configured destination/activity channel ID.
RANK_ROLE_IDS	JSON rank-name to role-ID map; include every rank Ricky Bot may replace.
AWARDABLE_ROLE_IDS	Comma-separated non-rank qualification/unit role IDs only.
TIME_ZONE_LABEL	Configured display label, such as MST.

Example rank map

```
{"Deputy":"123456789012345678","Senior Deputy":"234567890123456789","Corporal":"345678901234567890"}
```

Release commands

```
npm ci npm run preflight:deploy npm run register npm start
```

Sandbox commands

```
npm run preflight:demo npm run register:demo npm run start:demo
```

The startup gate checks the guild, every destination/activity channel, required permissions, role maps, role hierarchy, and the exact guild command set. A failed gate is a hard no-go.

Technical diagnostics

Ricky emits structured JSON errors to the process error stream with a timestamp, scope, interaction ID, command/custom ID, Discord code, and stack when available. It never logs submitted form values or tokens. Use the deployment supervisor's log viewer (for example, docker compose logs -f --tail=100); the PAB audit channel is reserved for personnel-action receipts. Modal submissions are acknowledged before slow Discord fetches so mobile users receive a specific Ricky validation/error message instead of Discord's generic banner.

8. First-day commissioning checklist

1. Create or confirm the PAB records channels and permissions.

2. Create or confirm inert category separator roles; give them no permissions and do not assign them.
3. Copy IDs with Developer Mode enabled; verify each ID against the visible name before writing .env.
4. Place Ricky Bot's actual assigned role above every configured rank and award role.
5. Run `npm run preflight:demo` or `npm run preflight:deploy`; stop on any failure.
6. Start exactly one Ricky Bot process and confirm the startup readiness gate passes.
7. Run `/setup-status` and `/pab-health` as a server administrator.
8. Run one harmless test of training, department record, promotion-check, personnel-status, inactivity-review, announcement, award-role, remove-role, correction, search, and audit export.
9. Use a clean test member for role changes; never test against the server owner.
10. Verify the test member's baseline role is restored and `/pab-health` is green before handoff.

The repository's `COMMAND_TEST_REPORT.md` contains the controlled Discord command matrix and screenshot evidence from the TEST ONLY guild. Add birthday, renewal, reminder, and roster-comparison checks to the commissioning run when those optional features are enabled.

9. Troubleshooting

Message / symptom	Cause	Fix
Workflow is not ready yet	A required ID, map, channel, or allow-list is missing.	Run /setup-status; fill the protected config; restart; run /pab-health.
Move Ricky Bot above it	The actual role assigned to the bot is below a rank/award role.	Move the assigned Ricky Bot/controller role above every configured managed role. Do not move an unassigned role.
Bot cannot manage that member	Target is the server owner, at/above Ricky Bot, or protected by Discord hierarchy.	Move the actual assigned Ricky Bot role above the target's highest role (including PAB when PAB members are targets), or use a human-admin path. Never test role changes on the owner.
Role is not eligible	Role is not in AWARDBLE_ROLE_IDS, or is rank/managed/elevated.	Use a harmless allow-listed qualification/unit role. Never add PAB, Command, rank, moderator, or Administrator roles.
Enter time as...	Input does not match the validated range or selected zone.	Use the dropdowns or h:mm AM/PM - h:mm AM/PM in the selected timezone.
Preview expired	The configured approval lifetime elapsed. The action failed closed.	Use Renew before the deadline when more review time is needed, or rerun the command so current roles and facts are captured again.
Preview already being processed	The single-use approval was already claimed or the UI is stale.	Refresh the PAB queue, verify the destination receipt, and do not approve the same preview again.
Google roster comparison failed	The sheet is not configured, inaccessible, or not shared with the service account.	Set the protected Google variables, share the sheet with the service-account email, verify the range, and rerun /roster-sync.
Something went wrong in a form	Discord did not receive an acknowledgement, the bot stopped, or a network/permission error occurred.	Retry once, then inspect structured process logs. Ricky should return a specific validation or permission message; verify the bot is online and run /pab-health.
Commands missing or stale	Guild registration was not run after a command change.	Run the target guild register command, then restart through the release gate.
Second process refuses to start	The process lock is working.	Stop the old instance cleanly; never run two Ricky Bot processes for one token/guild.

Do not solve a Discord hierarchy failure by granting Administrator. The bot is deliberately designed to fail closed and report the missing capability.

10. Data, backups, and security

- Published records live in Discord channels according to the server's retention rules.
- data/pab.sqlite contains pending approvals and searchable receipt metadata. Protect it like PAB personnel data.
- /export-audit produces a private JSON backup for an authorized server administrator.
- Unapproved previews expire after PENDING_ACTION_TTL_MINUTES, reminders are deduplicated, and expired rows are eventually purged. Renewing never bypasses final permission or hierarchy checks.
- Opt-in birthday data stores month/day only. Delivery markers prevent duplicate annual notices.
- Google Sheets credentials are read-only and belong only in the protected host environment; the service-account JSON must never be committed.
- Activity tracking stores member ID, timestamp, source channel, and source event ID. It does not store message content and is limited to ACTIVITY_CHANNEL_IDS.

- The bot does not import IA, complaint, discipline, personnel-jacket, or historical roster data.
- Use Docker or a supervised process with one persistent data directory. Back up the SQLite file under the approved personnel-record procedure.

Secret handling

Never commit .env, paste DISCORD_TOKEN into Discord, place the token in a screenshot, or attach the SQLite database to a public channel. Rotate the token in the Developer Portal if it is exposed.

11. Ownership and updates

The repository is the source of truth for bot code, tests, release gates, command definitions, and documentation. The Discord guild is the source of truth for role positions, channel permissions, and server-specific IDs.

- Keep changes in a branch, run npm test, git diff --check, and the relevant preflight, then push to GitHub.
- Review the diff before deployment; never add .env or data/.
- Register commands only for the intended guild and maintenance window.
- After deployment, run /setup-status, /pab-health, and a sandbox or controlled live smoke test.
- If a workflow changes, update README.md, ADMIN_HANDOFF.md, COMMAND_TEST_REPORT.md, and this manual together.

Current validation baseline

Check	Expected result
npm test	38 tests passed in the current release baseline.
npm run preflight:demo	Demo IDs and protected credentials pass validation.
DEPLOY_CONFIG_ENV_FILE=.env.demo.example npm run preflight:deploy	Candidate deployment configuration passes without printing secrets.
/setup-status + /pab-health	All IDs/channels/permissions/hierarchy ready in the target guild.
Discord command matrix	Registered commands exercised with previews, approvals, receipts, and guardrails; optional birthday and roster checks added when enabled.

12. One-page operator quick reference

If you remember only one thing: capture facts, review the private preview, approve intentionally, then verify the destination receipt.

Routine record

1. Run the command. 2. Select real members/roles. 3. Choose Today or enter MM/DD/YYYY. 4. Complete the guided form. 5. Read the preview. 6. Approve or cancel. 7. Verify the destination channel and receipt.

Promotion

/promotion creates a private request. Command approval is required. No promotion is automatic, including after training completion.

Role award/removal

Use only an allow-listed qualification/unit role. Preview approval is required. Rank, PAB, Command, managed, moderation, and Administrator roles are blocked.

Inactivity

Use /inactivity-review for neutral staff follow-up. Leave last-known activity blank to use the latest tracked activity. It never disciplines, removes, or changes access.

Correction

Copy Message Link from the original, run /correct-record, state the factual correction, approve, and preserve the original record.

Admin diagnostics

/setup-status = configuration. /pab-health = live permissions/hierarchy. /pab-dashboard = queue. /find-record = receipt search. /export-audit = private backup. /roster-sync = read-only Google comparison. /my-birthday and /remove-birthday = member-controlled opt-in.

This document is an operating manual for Ricky Bot. Server-specific policy, retention, role names, and authorization decisions remain under the server owner's control.